

Professional User Manual

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This manual explains core workflows for employees, HR admins, Systems operators, and IT governance admins.

Quick navigation

- Employee onboarding and feed usage
- HR publishing and employee management
- Systems monitoring and recovery tasks
- IT governance and recovery oversight
- Operational checks and troubleshooting

Communications and Alert Center User Manual

1. Purpose

Communications and Alert Center is a secure, installable employee communication application with four operational surfaces:

- **Employee portal** for updates, alerts, acknowledgements, and weather.
- **HR portal** for publishing notices and managing employees.
- **Systems portal** for operational settings, monitoring, and technical administration.
- **IT portal** for governance, recovery oversight, and administrative account control.

This manual is intended for non-technical operators, administrators, and support staff.

2. System Access and Roles

2.1 Routes

- Launcher: <https://<your-host>/palzivalerts> (internal shared entry)
- Employee portal: <https://<your-host>/palzivalerts/employee> (share this URL with employees)
- HR portal: <https://<your-host>/palzivalerts/hr>
- Systems portal: <https://<your-host>/palzivalerts/webmaster>
- IT portal: <https://<your-host>/palzivalerts/it>

Notes:

- Employees should use [/palzivalerts/employee](https://<your-host>/palzivalerts/employee) directly rather than the internal launcher.
- Signed-out HR, Systems, and IT access can begin directly on their own portal routes.
- Employee installs and shortcuts should open the employee portal. Admin consoles are intentionally omitted from shortcuts.
- Legacy routes ([/employee](https://<your-host>/palzivalerts/employee), [/hr](https://<your-host>/palzivalerts/hr), [/webmaster](https://<your-host>/palzivalerts/webmaster), [/it](https://<your-host>/palzivalerts/it), [/admin](https://<your-host>/palzivalerts/admin)) redirect to the branded [/palzivalerts](https://<your-host>/palzivalerts) paths.
- Public pages are only accessible after authentication.

2.2 User Roles

Role	Purpose	Typical Action
Employee	Read only	View posts, save/weather, acknowledge notices
HR Admin	HR	Publish updates, add/edit employees, manage HR admin users
Systems	Operations	Run health checks, manage diagnostics, recover services
IT	Governance	Account structure, critical recovery, policy and audit oversight

2.3 Authentication Best Practices

- Use named accounts only (do not create shared "admin" credentials).
 - Use strong unique passwords.
 - Rotate admin recovery tokens if there is any security concern.
 - Log in only over HTTPS.
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3. How to Use the Employee Portal

3.1 First Time Setup on Phone

1. Open the employee URL in Chrome or Safari.
2. Sign in with your employee credentials.
3. Tap **Enable alerts** when prompted if push notifications are supported.
4. Optional: install to home screen (Add to Home Screen).

3.2 Everyday Use

- **Feed**: shows active notices in reverse chronological order.
- **Weather card**: managed by HR; shows latest saved location forecast.
- **Acknowledge important posts**: tap acknowledgement controls where required.
- **Offline behavior**: app shell works offline; latest content syncs when connection returns.

3.3 Push Notifications

- Employees receive alerts only after permission is granted and service worker registration succeeds.
 - If alerts do not appear, verify browser support and notification permissions in device settings.
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4. How to Use the HR Portal

4.1 Sign In

1. Open the HR portal URL.
2. Sign in with your HR admin credentials.
3. Confirm **HR Control Center** opens before you begin publishing or account work.

4.2 Publish an Update

1. Create a post with title and content.
2. Select severity and urgency options if applicable.
3. Choose publish target (employee feed / alert / both).

4. Save and confirm delivery.

4.3 Manage Employees

- Add employee accounts with unique usernames.
- Update account details as people join or leave.
- Deactivate users when roles change or employment ends.

4.4 HR Operational Checklist

- Post at least one test post at start of day during operational changes.
 - Verify new posts appear in employee view immediately.
 - Keep critical alerts concise and avoid duplicate urgent messages.
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5. How to Use the Systems Portal

5.1 Sign In

1. Open the Systems portal URL.
2. Log in with Systems credentials.
3. Confirm **Systems Command Center** opens and the summary cards load.

5.2 Health Monitoring

Run or verify:

- Employee route returns 200.
- HR and Systems routes load successfully.
- API health endpoint is healthy.
- Logs are writing and rotating normally.

5.3 Recovery Tasks

- If login or public route issues occur, start with health-check and service status checks.
 - Restart the app only through established runbook procedures.
 - Use backup/restore only with a fresh backup taken first.
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6. IT Governance Role (When Enabled)

6.1 Sign In

1. Open the IT portal URL.
2. Sign in with your IT credentials.
3. Confirm the IT control center opens before making governance changes.

- Manage governance:
 - Named admin account control and recovery.
 - Audit and security event access.
 - High-level company operations and governance settings.
 - IT actions should be limited to control-plane administration, not daily posting.
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7. Install, Deploy, and Run

7.1 Local Development

1. Install dependencies: `npm install`
2. Start app: `npm start`
3. Open the routes in section 2.1.

7.2 Production (Windows + Cloudflare Tunnel)

- Run the app on port 3116.
- Use the provided startup and tunnel scripts to enable automatic recovery.
- Ensure `PUBLIC_BASE_URL` is set correctly before startup.
- Keep scheduled tasks and cloudflared service monitoring active.

7.3 Required Environment Variables

- `PUBLIC_BASE_URL`
 - `TRUST_PROXY_ADDRESSES`
 - `SITE_NAME`, `SITE_SHORT_NAME` (branding)
 - `SITE_SUBTITLE` (branding)
 - Recovery tokens as configured for your operational model.
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8. Backup and Recovery

8.1 Backup Frequency

- Before each release.
- At minimum once per day.

8.2 Restore Process

1. Stop updates in progress.
2. Take a new backup.
3. Restore from selected timestamped archive.
4. Restart with runbook commands.
5. Run health checks before users resume normal operations.

8.3 Recovery Rules

- Never restore over live data without a fresh backup.
 - Never restore from unknown or modified archives.
 - Validate URL and proxy settings after restore.
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9. Security and Compliance

- Use unique user credentials and strong passwords.
 - Limit shared device usage.
 - Keep admin credentials out of chat, screenshots, and source control.
 - Enable alerting for repeated failed logins and lockout events.
 - Rotate credentials after role changes and employee departures.
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10. Troubleshooting

10.1 Employees Cannot Sign In

- Confirm credentials and account status.
- Check if account is disabled or password changed.
- Verify you are on the correct branded portal route.

10.2 Push Alerts Not Arriving

- Confirm browser supports notifications and service workers.
- Ensure HTTPS is active.
- Confirm the employee completed registration on the device.

10.3 Missing Updates

- Refresh from a stable connection.
- Check app version and network.
- Verify HR publication status and expiry rules.

10.4 Portal Fails to Load

- Confirm server/host is running.
- Verify health checks for `/api/health`.
- Check runtime logs for startup or proxy errors.

10.5 Escalation

- If issue persists beyond 15 minutes during work hours, escalate to the operations lead.
 - Provide:
 - time range
 - username/role involved
 - browser/device
 - exact error text
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11. Logging and Support

11.1 What to include in support requests

- User account and role.
- Time window of issue.
- Repro steps.
- Screenshots (without credentials).
- Error codes/messages.

11.2 Expected Standard

- Confirm healthy access for the employee route first. If internal staff are affected too, then check the launcher and the direct HR, Systems, or IT routes.
 - Confirm signed-out admin access starts on the intended HR, Systems, or IT route, then verify login from that path.
 - Confirm successful login and API health before deeper diagnosis.
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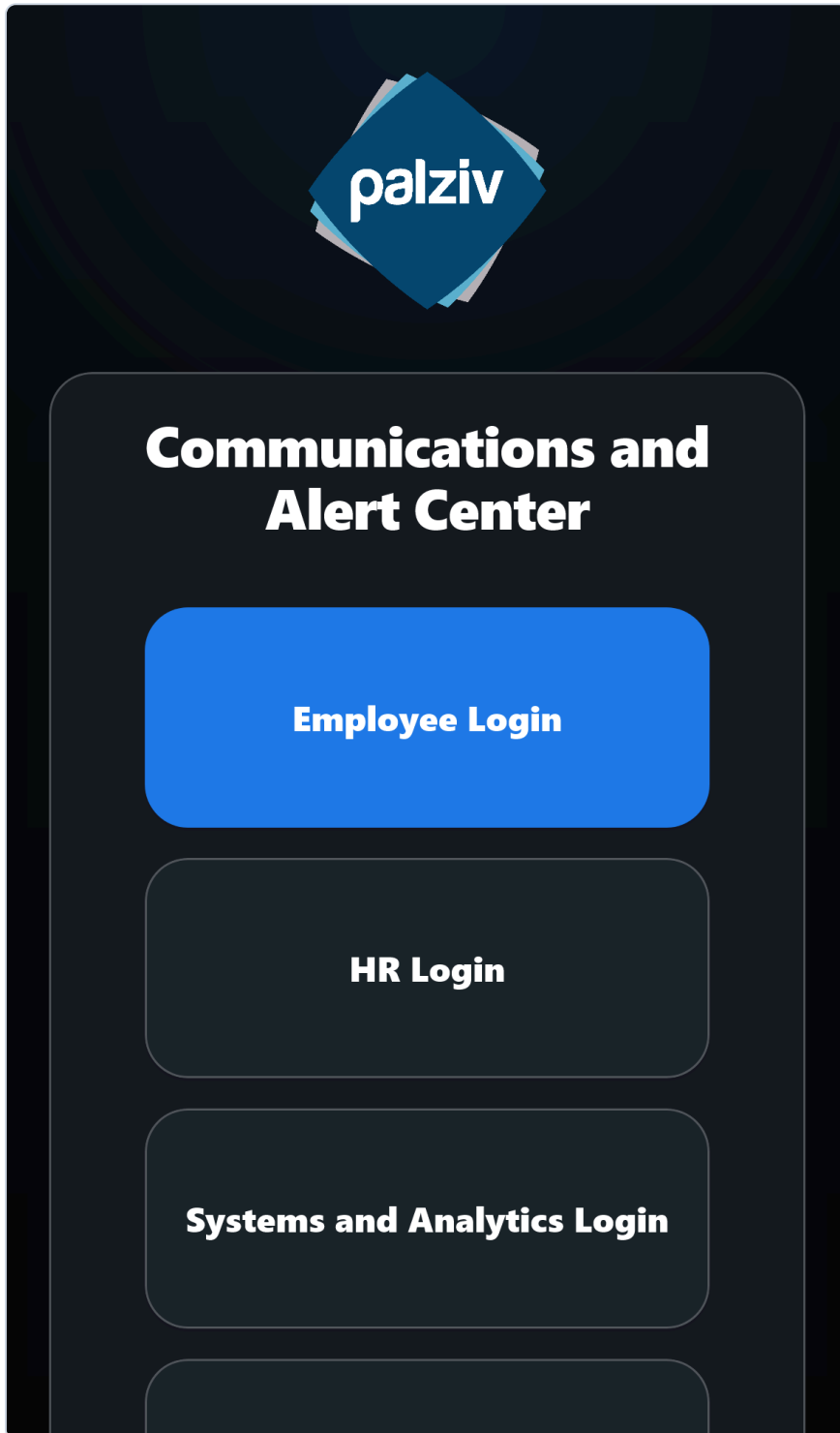
12. Versioning and Stewardship

- Keep this manual updated with every release and role/process change.
- Store it with the deployment package so operators and admins can access the same document.
- Review monthly for role changes, recovery procedures, and security updates.

Appendix: Screenshots

Use these for quick recognition and training handoff.

Launcher page (/palzivalerts)





Employee access

Employee sign in

Username

Password

Sign In

HR login route (/palzivalerts/hr)



HR ADMIN

HR sign in

USERNAME

PASSWORD

SIGN IN

[FORGOT PASSWORD?](#) [BACK TO LAUNCHER](#)

Systems login route (/palzivalerts/webmaster)



SYSTEM OPS ADMIN

System Ops sign in

USERNAME

PASSWORD

SIGN IN

[FORGOT PASSWORD?](#) [BACK TO LAUNCHER](#)

IT login route (/palzivalerts/it)



IT ADMIN

IT sign in

USERNAME

PASSWORD

SIGN IN

BACK TO LAUNCHER